

Haven Cafe product demand study

Osara, Salalah

Year-round and Khareef menu opportunities - Osara, Salalah - 22 July 2026

Executive conclusion

Haven already carries most of the drinks that define Salalah's specialty-cafe market. The clearest year-round hero is the **Iced Spanish Latte**, followed by Hot Spanish Latte, core espresso drinks, indulgent cakes/cookies, matcha, and flavored iced coffees. V60 matters strongly to specialty credibility but is less likely to be the largest unit seller.

Khareef changes the opportunity rather than completely reversing it. Visitor volume rises dramatically while average temperatures fall to roughly 20-28 C. Iced Spanish Latte should remain a hero, but the mix should shift toward **Hot Spanish Latte, V60, hot chocolate, karak, warm desserts, family sharing formats, and products with a recognisable Dhofari story**.

The priority recommendations are:

1. Treat Iced Spanish Latte as Haven's permanent traffic anchor and protect its quality and speed.
2. Build a Khareef hot-drink campaign around Hot Spanish Latte, premium hot chocolate and one Dhofari signature.
3. Add a hot/iced Pistachio Latte and two focused matcha variants.
4. Add an affordable cookie or mini dessert and one savory croissant/sandwich to increase attachment and average ticket.
5. Introduce one genuinely local signature using coconut, local tropical fruit, honey or Hojari frankincense, rather than several generic syrup drinks.
6. Add premium karak cautiously. It is a major local category, but Haven must distinguish it from 300-500 baisa roadside karak.
7. Do not expand into a large frappe, juice or breakfast menu until POS evidence and service capacity justify it.

Method and confidence

No public source provides audited annual unit sales for independent Salalah cafes. This study therefore combines four demand proxies:

- repeated appearance in **Picks for you / bestseller** sections across more than 15 current Salalah delivery menus;
- review labels such as "Amazing" and repeated hero placement;
- prevalence across Salalah and wider Oman specialty menus;
- Khareef visitor, weather and commercial-activity evidence from official Omani sources.

Talabat merchandising can include promotions or algorithmic placement, so one listing is weak evidence. Repetition across many unrelated cafes is much stronger. The conclusions below are directional demand rankings, not a substitute for Haven's POS data.

The public-menu sample included Patria, Key Coffee, Lantana, Like Cafe, Dose, 2 Oz, X Cafe, ABAQ, Aventus, Rovana, Top 10, Solo, Olea, TOQA and Mute, plus specialist/bakery comparisons such as Vian Croissants, Karak & Tawa and Saffron.

Year-round demand ranking

Rank	Product family	Demand signal	On Haven menu?	Strategic reading
1	Iced Spanish Latte	Appears in the hero/bestseller set of at least 11 of 15 sampled specialty cafes	Yes	Permanent traffic anchor
2	Hot Spanish Latte	Repeated hero at roughly 9-10 sampled cafes	Yes	Strong all year; rises in Khareef
3	Cakes, cookies and sweet pastry	Frequently paired with coffee and repeatedly placed in hero sets	Partly	Haven lacks a low-price attachment
4	Classic latte and Americano	Less visually promoted but consistently ordered and retained	Yes	Essential repeat-business products
5	Flavored iced coffee	White mocha, caramel and pistachio repeatedly receive strong ratings	Partly	Pistachio coffee is missing
6	Matcha and matcha variants	Rapidly expanding; vanilla foam and fruit variants now appear as heroes	Classic only	High-growth gap
7	V60 / iced V60	Broad menu presence and specialty credibility; fewer bestseller placements	Yes	Keep for authority, not only volume
8	San Sebastian and chocolate desserts	Repeated across Salalah menus and hero sections	Yes	Strong, but presentation and pricing matter
9	Mojito, iced tea and karkade	Broadly available; useful in heat and for non-coffee groups	Yes	Retain a focused range
10	Smoothies and milkshakes	Common but less consistently heroic except pistachio	Yes	Keep selective; watch ingredient cost

Why Spanish Latte is the anchor

The repeated signal is unusually strong:

- [Patria Cafe](#) places Cold and Hot Spanish Latte in Picks for you.
- [Key Coffee](#) leads with cold Spanish latte and also features hot Spanish latte.
- [Lantana](#) features iced and hot Spanish lattes alongside premium cake.
- [2 Oz](#), [AB AQ](#), [Aventus](#), [Rovana](#), [Top 10](#) and [Solo](#) show the same pattern.
- [Mute](#) extends Spanish Latte into a one-litre sharing format.

Haven's existing Iced Spanish Latte is therefore correctly positioned as "Most Ordered." It should be the fastest, most consistent drink on the bar and the default base for attachment offers.

The quieter but durable core

Latte, Americano, cappuccino and espresso do not always receive hero photography because they are familiar rather than novel. They remain important for repeat customers and quality judgement. Mute's featured set includes latte and Americano; Solo features a low-calorie iced latte; Top 10 includes classic latte; Lantana features iced Americano. These products should not be displaced by trend drinks.

V60: authority more than mass volume

V60 is present across 2 Oz, Dose, Lantana, X Cafe, Watan, Olea, Mute and many other Salalah menus. It establishes specialty credentials and appeals to coffee enthusiasts, but it appears less often than Spanish Latte in public bestseller sets. Haven should maintain two clear choices at most - a dependable house V60 and a rotating premium/fruit-forward origin - rather than building a large slow-moving bean list.

Matcha: a growth category, not a fad to ignore

Haven has a classic Iced Matcha, but the market is moving toward layered, flavored and visually distinctive versions:

- [Olea](#) features Iced Matcha with Vanilla Sweet Cold Foam in its hero set.
- [Matcha House Oman](#) lists Iced Sakura Matcha Latte as its leading bestseller.
- [TOQA](#) maintains a Matcha & Signature Selection and a New & Trending section.
- [Tim Hortons Salalah](#) lists an iced mango matcha.
- Regional specialty reporting in 2026 describes matcha as moving from a niche wellness product into the mainstream. [Khaleej Times](#)

The opportunity is real, but Haven should not offer six nearly identical matchas. Two variants are enough to test demand.

Khareef demand outlook

Khareef is a large, measurable demand shock:

- Dhofar attracted **1,048,000 Khareef visitors in 2024**. [Ministry of Heritage and Tourism](#)
- From 21 June to 15 August 2025, arrivals reached **827,115**, 2.1% above the equivalent 2024 period. [Oman News Agency](#)
- The 2023 season produced about **OMR 103 million** of visitor spending. [Oman News Agency](#)
- Official reporting recorded a clear rise in demand for restaurants, cafeterias, hotels and entertainment facilities during Khareef 2025. [Oman News Agency](#)
- Visit Oman describes Khareef temperatures around **20-28 C**, compared with much hotter Gulf summers. [Visit Oman](#)

This means Haven should plan for both more transactions and a different customer mix: tourists, families, GCC road-trip groups, first-time visitors and people staying out later at destination sites such as Osara.

Expected Khareef product ranking

Khareef priority	Product	Expected change vs rest of year	Evidence and action
1	Iced Spanish Latte	Volume rises with total traffic; share may soften slightly	Keep as hero and batch mise-en-place carefully
2	Hot Spanish Latte	Strong share increase	Lead the seasonal hot menu
3	Hot chocolate / mocha	Strong share increase in drizzle and cooler evenings	Create one premium Khareef version
4	V60 and Americano	Moderate increase among coffee-focused visitors	Offer clear origin/story and fast workflow
5	Karak / saffron-cardamom tea	Strong visitor and family appeal	Test a Haven-quality version and small dallah
6	Warm cake / San Sebastian / brownie	Higher attachment with hot drinks	Serve warm; create pairing rather than discounting coffee
7	Dhofari signature	Strong tourist curiosity and shareability	Use local coconut, honey, fruit or Hojari story
8	Matcha	Remains strong, especially with younger visitors	Keep classic plus one visual fruit/foam variant
9	Karkade / iced tea / mojito	Absolute sales rise but likely lower share	Keep concise rather than expanding flavors
10	Smoothies / milkshakes	Family and child demand; weather-sensitive	Keep pistachio and one fruit option prominent

Khareef-specific behavior to design for

1. **Mixed hot and cold orders.** A family may order hot Spanish, iced Spanish, matcha and a child-friendly drink together. Bar flow must handle both stations.
2. **Higher group attachment.** Boxes, mini pastries and shareable desserts become more relevant. Mute promotes one-litre drinks; Saffron promotes dallah and sandwich boxes.
3. **Tourist interest in place.** Fresh coconut water and locally grown bananas, papayas and guavas are specifically sought by visitors during Khareef. [Arabian Stories / ONA reporting](#)
4. **A cooler-weather permission to indulge.** Premium hot chocolate, warmed brownie and cinnamon/cardamom products make more sense than in Salalah's hotter shoulder months.
5. **Queue sensitivity.** Large seasonal traffic makes a five-minute specialty preparation costly at peak. Keep slow signatures limited and pre-batch only where quality and food safety allow.

Gap analysis: what Haven is missing

Priority 1: add or test soon

Missing product	Demand case	Suggested role	Indicative price
Pistachio Latte, hot and iced	Pistachio coffee receives strong ratings locally; Haven only has a pistachio shake	Permanent premium flavored coffee	OMR 1.900 hot / 2.000-2.100 iced
Strawberry Matcha or Mango Matcha	Fruit matcha is growing and visually strong	Permanent after 6-week test	OMR 2.300-2.400
Vanilla Cold Foam Matcha	Directly validated in Olea's hero set	Alternative to fruit matcha, not an additional six-SKU line	OMR 2.300
Premium cookie / mini brownie	Cookies repeatedly appear in hero sets; easy coffee attachment	Permanent grab-and-go	OMR 0.900-1.300
Plain or egg-cheese croissant	Croissant and sandwich products appear in cafe hero sets and raise ticket size	One light savory item	OMR 1.000 plain / 1.800-2.200 filled
Premium Karak	Karak and cardamom/saffron variants are verified local bestsellers	Permanent or Khareef-led test	OMR 0.600-0.800 cup

Evidence for pastry and karak demand is particularly direct:

- [Vian Croissants](#) features hot chocolate and multiple filled croissants in Picks for you.
- [Olea](#) features club/halloumi sandwiches, Belgian chocolate cookies and matcha.
- [Top 10](#) leads with an egg-croissant and orange-juice meal.
- [Karak & Tawa](#) leads with large karak and saffron karak.
- [Yalla Karak](#) identifies Karak Tea, Karak Cardamom and Salalah bread as its bestsellers.

Priority 2: Khareef and destination signatures

Concept	Why it fits Haven and Osara	Test format	Indicative price
Khareef Spanish Latte	Familiar hero with cardamom/cinnamon warmth	Hot seasonal LTO	OMR 1.900

Concept	Why it fits Haven and Osara	Test format	Indicative price
Hojari Honey Latte	Gives Haven a Dhofari story without copying a generic flavor menu	Hot and iced signature	OMR 2.200-2.400
Coconut Cold Brew	Connects cold brew to Salalah's most recognisable refreshment	Iced seasonal/permanent test	OMR 2.300-2.500
Mango-Karkade	Local/tropical, colorful and caffeine-free	Khareef refresher	OMR 1.800-2.000
Omani coffee and halwa service	Strong visitor ritual and group appeal	Single tray or small pot	OMR 1.500 single / 4.000-4.500 sharing
Khareef Hot Chocolate	Weather-led indulgence; easy pairing with brownie	One premium recipe	OMR 1.900-2.100

Frankincense should be handled with restraint. Dhofar's Hojari frankincense is an authentic and powerful story, and local concepts such as [HOJAR Cafe](#) explicitly build their identity around it. Haven should validate culinary safety, dosage and taste before putting frankincense directly into a drink. Honey, aroma, naming and presentation can express the story without producing a medicinal flavor.

Priority 3: test only if capacity allows

- **One-litre Spanish Latte or Matcha:** useful for families, gatherings and pre-orders, as shown by Mute, but it can dilute quality and complicate storage. Offer by pre-order first.
- **Small savory box:** relevant to Khareef groups and Osara gatherings; test with a bakery partner rather than building a kitchen.
- **Fresh coconut service:** highly authentic, but storage, cutting, waste, hygiene and roadside price competition are significant. A Coconut Cold Brew may fit Haven better operationally.
- **Low-calorie Spanish Latte:** Solo features a low-calorie iced latte, suggesting a real subsegment. Test only after the core menu is stable.

Products not recommended for expansion

1. **More mojito flavors.** Haven already has four. The category is useful, but additional syrups will not strengthen the brand.
2. **A large frappe menu.** Dose and many competitors carry frappes, but the category adds equipment time, toppings and stock complexity. One seasonal blended hero is enough.
3. **A full fresh-juice list.** Salalah has strong roadside fruit specialists. Haven should own one or two designed signatures, not imitate a juice shop.
4. **A full breakfast kitchen.** Breakfast and sandwiches can sell, but a small Osara cafe can lose speed and consistency quickly. Start with supplied pastry and one filled croissant.
5. **Many V60 origins.** Rotate one premium origin alongside a house choice; do not trap cash in slow beans.
6. **Six matcha variants.** Launch one fruit matcha and one creamy matcha, then retain only the winner.

Recommended Haven menu architecture

Permanent heroes

- Iced Spanish Latte
- Hot Spanish Latte
- Latte / Iced Latte
- Americano / Iced Americano
- House V60 hot or iced

- Haven Passion Fruit Cold Brew
- Iced Matcha
- Karkade
- Hot Chocolate
- San Sebastian Cheesecake
- Brownie

Permanent additions to test

- Pistachio Latte hot and iced
- One fruit matcha
- One cookie or mini brownie
- One plain or savory croissant
- Premium karak

Khareef limited menu

- Khareef Spanish Latte
- Hojari Honey Latte or Coconut Cold Brew
- Khareef Hot Chocolate
- Warm brownie or warm San Sebastian pairing
- Small Omani coffee/halwa or karak sharing service

Candidates for simplification after POS review

- Iced Cappuccino if it contributes less than 1-2% of drink sales
- Macchiato if poorly understood or ordered
- Overlapping hazelnut/caramel/mocha variants
- The weakest two of four mojitos
- The weakest two of three flavored iced teas
- Any smoothie/milkshake with high waste and low contribution

Commercial recommendations

Protect the bestseller rather than discounting it

Do not use deep discounts on Iced Spanish Latte. Pair it with a low-cost cookie or mini brownie. A bundle can improve value perception while preserving the price of the hero drink.

Use two menu boards during Khareef

1. **Fast favorites:** Iced Spanish, Hot Spanish, Americano, Latte, Karkade, Karak, cookie.
2. **Haven signatures:** Passion Fruit Cold Brew, Hojari Honey Latte, Coconut Cold Brew, fruit matcha.

This separates speed from discovery and prevents a 50-item decision problem at peak times.

Merchandise by time of day

- Morning/early afternoon: Americano, latte, V60, croissant.
- Sunset/evening: Iced Spanish, Hot Spanish, signature cold brew, matcha.
- Cool/drizzly Khareef evenings: hot Spanish, hot chocolate, karak, warm dessert.
- Family/group visits: pairing, mini box and small sharing service.

Measurement plan

Public signals identify what to test; Haven's POS should decide what survives.

Track every item weekly using:

- units sold;
- mix percentage;
- net revenue excluding VAT;
- recipe and packaging cost;
- contribution margin per item;
- preparation time;
- waste;
- attachment rate;
- hour and weather/season;
- new vs returning customer where loyalty data permits.

Use four test windows:

1. **Six normal weeks** before Khareef.
2. **First two Khareef weeks** for launch learning.
3. **Four peak Khareef weeks** for stable demand.
4. **Four post-Khareef weeks** to decide which seasonal products deserve permanence.

Promotion success should be judged by gross profit per 100 transactions, not only units. A new product that sells well but slows the bar, creates waste or replaces a higher-margin bestseller may reduce total profit.

Recommended action list

Implement now

1. Make Iced and Hot Spanish Latte the first two menu heroes.
2. Add one cookie/mini dessert attachment.
3. Cost and test Pistachio Latte hot and iced.
4. Test one fruit matcha against one vanilla-foam matcha; retain the winner.
5. Source one reliable plain/savory croissant from a bakery partner.
6. Prepare Khareef recipe cards and bar workflows before seasonal traffic peaks.

Implement for Khareef

7. Launch one hot seasonal hero and one local cold signature.
8. Add a differentiated premium karak or small sharing pot.
9. Serve brownie or San Sebastian warm and promote a pairing.
10. Put the fast-favorites menu at the order point and the discovery menu beside the queue.

Validate before committing

11. Conduct an in-person Osara/Avicennia bestseller check at three dayparts.
12. Ask the top 100 Haven customers which missing product they would buy, using a forced choice rather than an open question.
13. Require every new SKU to reach at least 3% mix or deliver a clear strategic role after its test.
14. Remove low-volume duplicates after eight weeks of POS evidence.

Bottom line

Haven has the market's essential drinks, but it currently underuses three demand pools: **premium pistachio/matcha**, **low-friction food attachment**, and a **Salalah-specific product story**. The menu should not become much larger. It should become clearer: Spanish Latte as the volume engine, V60 and cold brew as specialty proof, matcha as controlled growth, pastry as ticket attachment, and one Dhofari signature as the reason to remember Haven after leaving Osara.